

WORD IMPROVEMENT CDS PYQ

Each of the sentences in the following items has an underlined word, followed by four choices. Select the most appropriate option that is an improvement of the underlined word in the context of the sentence, and mark your response on the Answer Sheet accordingly.

[CDS 2025 (1)]

1. The officer under suspension felt intimated by the committee members during his interrogation regarding the allegations against him.
(a) inculcated (b) intimidated
(c) asphyxiated (d) annulled
2. Amongst them all, she was the only one with the perquisite to understand the complexity of the situation.
(a) perspicacity
(b) perniciousness
(c) peremptoriness
(d) presumptuousness
3. At the official function organised for the attending dignitaries, guests arrived in scrumptious attire for the banquet.
(a) synergistic (b) stentorian
(c) sumptuous (d) scrumpy
4. The lake atop the mountain has always been the lyre for intrepid hikers.
(a) link (b) line
(c) life (d) lure
5. The candidates went through an intensive instruction process before their absorption into the service.
(a) immersion (b) intimation
(c) induction (d) unction
6. The office memorandum directed personnel to minimise their consumption of office stationery by up to twenty percent.
(a) supervise (b) surmise
(c) lower (d) reduce
7. The announcement of an unexpected bonus led to great tumult among the staff.
(a) merriment (b) trepidation
(c) upheaval (d) uproar

8. The scurrilous remarks in the article were met with great joy by the leadership of the company.

(a) laudatory (b) reviling
(c) scathing (d) upbraiding

9. His inappropriate behaviour earned plaudits from his colleagues.

(a) sanctimoniousness (b) triumph
(c) opprobrium (d) banter

10. The enormity of the mountain range stunned the visitors to the hill station.

(a) eternity (b) enormousness
(c) extremity (d) simulacrum

Each of the sentences in the following items has an underlined word, followed by four choices. Select the most appropriate option that is an improvement of the underlined word in the context of the sentence, and mark your response on the Answer Sheet accordingly.

[CDS 2025 (2)]

11. The opposing political parties nevertheless took a bilateral position in the national interest.

(a) impartial (b) intermittent
(c) perilous (d) bipartisan

12. Although she had sampled food from all the restaurants in the food court, she remained indefinite towards the culinary fare on offer.

(a) imperious (b) indifferent
(c) imperiled (d) disinterested

13. The attitude of the whalers was marked by antipathy towards the marine life they had to encounter.

(a) sympathy (b) empathy
(c) indifference (d) animus

14. The family was rendered diligent due to the crash in the share market.

(a) indifferent (b) intransigent
(c) indignant (d) apathetic

15. He had cultivated such great temperance in his personality that he was impassioned in his dealing with the vicissitudes of life.

(a) dispassionate (b) dissipation
(c) perfunctory (d) disambiguated

- 16.** The document was discerned to be a postscript, where clearly an earlier manuscript had been replaced by a new one.
 (a) parchment (b) palmist
 (c) pastiche (d) montage
- 17.** He was accused of simulism for having copied from someone else without due acknowledgement.
 (a) sensationalism (b) institutionalism
 (c) plagiarism (d) spoonerism
- 18.** The domineering manager behaved in a paternal manner with his subordinates, not allowing them to decide for themselves.

- (a) prim (b) petulant
 (c) presumptuous (d) paternalistic

- 19.** Much to their disappointment, the team leader spared no more than a reflective glance at the draft plan drawn up by his team.
 (a) perfunctory (b) precise
 (c) engaging (d) egregious
- 20.** Her actions were considered salutary because they were done without good reason or cause.
 (a) ingratiated (b) gratuitous
 (c) grating (d) gargantuan

ANSWER KEY

1.	b	2.	a	3.	c	4.	d	5.	c	6.	d	7.	d	8.	b	9.	c	10.	b
11.	d	12.	b	13.	d	14.	c	15.	a	16.	c	17.	c	18.	d	19.	a	20.	b